

- `varmyColor = "Orange";`

Now create a new Regular Expression that is looking for a simple pattern. In this instance, the pattern is that the myColor stringvalue must start with an O.

- `varcolorRegExp:RegExp = /O/;`

You can write a trace script to test your movie:

- `trace(colorRegExp.test( myColor ) );`

The value in the Output panel is True. Let's extend what you can do with Regular Expressions by adding a pattern that looks for an email address. Start by adding anew e-mail string with a valid email address:

- `varemail:String = "test@thinkdigit.com";`

Next, create a new Regular Expression that is looking for a pattern-structure in your email:

- `varemailRegExp:RegExp = /^[a-zA-Z0-9 _-]+)@([a-zA-Z0-9.-]+)\.([a-zA-Z]{2,4})$/i;`

The pattern is looking for a combination of alpha-numeric special character formats separated by an @ sign and suffix ".". Add the following trace statement to see whether or not the pattern works:

- `trace( "Is this email valid? " + emailRegExp.test( email ) )`

Test the movie and you will get the following response in the Output panel:

- Is this email valid? True

Change the email address to just "Digit" a pattern that does not match the Regular Expression. When you test the movie you will see that the Regular Expression returns a false response.

Controlling text

In many ways you do not need to work on the stage at all when using AS3. All visual objects can be programmatically created. The easiest way to see this is in using the Text object to create dynamic text fields on the stage.

1. To create a dynamic text field, create a new AS3 file with an associated class called text.
2. The Actions panel will open showing you the text Class file. Add the libraries to be imported into your file:

- `import flash.display.Sprite;`
- `import flash.text.TextField;`
- `import flash.text.TextFieldAutoSize;`
- `import flash.text.TextFormat;`

3. Now you need to insert a private variable that will be used to define the